CCAR-P · DOMAIN 3 · INTEGRATION · 19% OF THE EXAM

The D3 Multiple-Response Drill

Select TWO, select THREE, all or nothing

30 items · 18 select-TWO + 12 select-THREE · one sitting, 55 minutes · sealed key
Weighted to the four new objectives: 3.2 authorization, 3.4 observability, 3.5 chunking, 3.6 retrieval (5 items each)

Items per objective



Prepared by Ravi Ranjan · CCAO-F, CCDV-F & CCAR-F

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ALL OR NOTHING

How this drill works

On the real exam a multiple-response item says how many options to pick, and it scores only if you pick exactly the right ones. There is no half credit. This drill trains that format on Domain 3 alone, so the content is familiar and the format is the thing you practise.

1 · Count
Read the last line: TWO or THREE.

→

2 · Find the tell
Underline what rules the extra out.

→

3 · Mark the sure
Tick what you know is right.

→

4 · Strike the sure-wrong
Cross what you know is wrong.

→

5 · Decide the rest
Let the tell pick among what is left.

THE ODDS · what partial knowledge buys you on a 5-option item. With k correct options already sure and e wrong options struck, a guess among the rest is right with probability 1 / C(5 − k − e, s − k), where s is how many to select.

You are sure of…	Select TWO of 5	Select THREE of 5
nothing	1 / C(5,2) = 1/10 = 10%	1 / C(5,3) = 1/10 = 10%
one wrong option struck	1 / C(4,2) = 1/6 ≈ 17%	1 / C(4,3) = 1/4 = 25%
one correct option	1 / C(4,1) = 1/4 = 25%	1 / C(4,2) = 1/6 ≈ 17%
one correct + one wrong	1 / C(3,1) = 1/3 ≈ 33%	1 / C(3,2) = 1/3 ≈ 33%
two wrong options struck	1 / C(3,2) = 1/3 ≈ 33%	1 / C(3,3) = 1 = 100%
three wrong options struck	1 / C(2,2) = 1 = 100%	—

The three ways to miss · after marking, write O, U or C beside every miss on the sheet

OVER
You picked a tempting extra: usually an over-build (OE) or a process word (SD). The tell rules it out.

UNDER
You skipped a correct option because it looked too modest: a plain log line, a short-lived key, a header kept with a table.

COUNT
You picked the wrong number of options. The stem's last line says TWO or THREE; count before you mark.

Pass bar: ≥ 24 / 30, OVER + UNDER ≤ 4, no objective with 3 or more misses. Sit it in one sitting with a 55-minute timer. Re-sit only your misses 48 hours later, cold.

SQUARES · PICK EXACTLY THE NUMBER SHOWN · THEN MARK O / U / C ON MISSES

Answer sheet

	A	B	C	D	E	O	U	C
1 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
9 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
10 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
11 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
13 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
14 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
15 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	A	B	C	D	E	O	U	C
16 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
17 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
18 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
19 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
20 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
21 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
22 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
23 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
24 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
26 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
27 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
28 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
29 pick 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
30 pick 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

START THE 55-MINUTE TIMER

The drill

30 items · select TWO or THREE

1 Arjun Bose audits KAVI's tool configuration. Nine tool schemas ride along on every call at 2,314 tokens; the usage logs show that three tools carry the routine exception flow, and those three cost 811 tokens. The other six include `escalate_to_human`, which fires on only a small share of cases but is the path for anything KAVI must not settle alone. KAVI handles 40,000 calls a day. Which two statements belong in Arjun's recommendation? Select TWO.

- **A** The full trim to the three routine tools sets the ceiling on the saving: 1,503 tokens a call, or 60,120,000 tokens a day at 40,000 calls
- **B** Keep all nine tools and add a routing subagent that chooses which schemas to load for each call, so that no tool is lost
- **C** Before removing any of the other six, check what a missed call to each would cost as well as how often it is used
- **D** The 1,503 tokens saved are output tokens, so the main gain from the trim is a shorter reply on every call
- **E** Keep all nine and add a line to the system prompt telling KAVI to use only the tools that the case in front of it needs

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2 Godwit Insurance's fraud-investigation agent works one case for several hours. It calls `fetch_document` 60 to 80 times per case, each result about 3,000 tokens, and reads each document once. It calls `get_case_ledger` once at the start, and investigators need that ledger in view for the whole session. They also want the agent's notes on every document kept for the final report. By the fortieth document, input passes 120,000 tokens a call, cost climbs and the agent mixes up documents. Which two changes fit? Select TWO.

- **A** Add a system-prompt instruction telling the agent to disregard every document it has already finished reviewing
- **B** Have the agent record each document's key findings with the memory tool before older results are cleared
- **C** Turn on `clear_tool_uses_20250919` with its default settings, which clears older tool results and keeps the three most recent tool uses in context
- **D** Turn on `clear_tool_uses_20250919` context editing with `get_case_ledger` in `exclude_tools`, so old document results are cleared and the ledger stays
- **E** Let the context grow to the full 1M-token window, so all 80 documents fit at once and nothing ever has to be cleared

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3 Pelican Courier's delivery-exception pipeline has four stages: a small-model classifier, retrieval, a mid-tier drafting model and a checking step. Finance has set a ceiling of ₹3.50 per resolved exception; last month's invoice works out to ₹4.20, and nobody can say which stage caused the rise. The pipeline handles about 3,00,000 exceptions a month, and today it emits only request counts and error counts. Which three monitoring changes let the team find the stage and hold the ceiling? Select THREE.

- **A** Label the cost metric with each exception's ID as well, so that the most expensive individual exceptions can be listed on the dashboard
- **B** Review the monthly invoice against the ceiling at each month-end meeting and ask stage owners to keep their usage as lean as possible
- **C** Carry one trace ID through all four stages and record each span's token count, so a costly exception can be followed end to end
- **D** Alert the pipeline owner when daily cost per resolved exception exceeds ₹3.50
- **E** Emit input tokens, output tokens and cost for every call as metrics labelled by stage and model tier

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4 KAVI answers dispatchers' questions from 400 SOP documents that are heading-structured, written in mixed Hindi and English and updated weekly. For consignment KF-2481, the early pipeline, which cut SOPs into fixed-size chunks, retrieved the cancellation steps instead of SOP 214 §4, the customs e-way bill re-filing procedure, because that procedure had been cut across two chunks. Two weeks later, dispatchers also notice answers quoting SOP steps that were changed the previous Friday. Which two changes fix these problems? Select TWO.

- **A** Add a query-rewriting model that turns each dispatcher question into five variants before retrieval
- **B** Chunk the SOPs along their headings and sections, with a little overlap between neighbouring chunks
- **C** Translate all 400 SOPs into English before indexing, so that the embeddings compare like with like and mixed language stops confusing retrieval
- **D** Keep the fixed-size chunks and add a reranker over the top 150 candidates, so that the true §4 chunk rises above the cancellation steps
- **E** Re-index the changed SOPs on a weekly schedule, label chunks with their version and drop stale versions

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5 Rann Salt Works is building one MCP server for its brine-pond operations. It will be used by a cloud-hosted planning agent and by Claude desktop apps on office laptops, all reaching a server in the plant data room. Three capabilities are planned: reading any pond's current salinity, which the model should do whenever a question needs it; a daily tide-and-weather bulletin that the application attaches to each conversation; and a 'harvest-readiness review' that supervisors start from a menu. Which three design choices are correct? Select THREE.

- **A** Expose pond-salinity reading as a tool that the model invokes with the pond number
- **B** Run the server over stdio inside the plant data room, the simplest transport
- **C** Offer the harvest-readiness review as a prompt that supervisors pick from the client's menu
- **D** Offer the daily tide-and-weather bulletin as a prompt, so that the planning agent receives it automatically at the start of each conversation
- **E** Serve the MCP server over Streamable HTTP with OAuth, since every client reaches it across the network

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6 At Alder Bank in Dublin, a developer built an MCP server for account-servicing tools and ran it over stdio on her own laptop, where it used her login to reach the core banking API. The server is now moving to a shared host so that four teams' agents can call it over Streamable HTTP; only the collections team may use `freeze_card`, and the developer moves to another department next month. Which three changes does the move require? Select THREE.

- **A** Give the server its own service account for the core banking API
- **B** Check the calling team's scopes in the server code before `freeze_card` runs, and refuse the call when the scope is missing
- **C** Place the server inside the bank's private network so that only bank devices can reach it, which removes the need for per-team tokens and scopes
- **D** Require each team's agent to authenticate with its own short-lived OAuth token before any request is accepted
- **E** Keep the authentication setup unchanged, since the server ran safely over stdio for months

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7 Arjun Bose compares two ways to give KAVI its catalogue. Monolithic: every tool schema and all 400 SOP documents on every call, 362,460 tokens. Progressive: nine tool stubs at 25 tokens each, a 260-token header, 20 SOP summaries at 180 tokens each and one 120-token fetch of the SOP a case needs. The SOPs are updated weekly and most cases need at most one of them. Separately, a 4,500-token block of dispatch rules is identical on every call and used by every case. Which three statements should go into Arjun's design note? Select THREE.

- **A** Cache the full 362,460-token monolithic context instead, since cache reads are billed at a small fraction of the normal input price
- **B** Send the dispatch-rule block whole on every call and cache it
- **C** For the weekly-updated SOP library, send the catalogue and fetch a full document only when a case asks for it
- **D** Make the dispatch-rule block fetchable on demand too, so the whole design is progressive
- **E** The progressive design costs 4,205 tokens a call, which makes it about 86 times smaller than sending everything

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8 Alder Bank's card-services assistant has an SLA of p95 ≤ 5 s and an error rate below 1%. The on-call engineer receives about 350 alerts a week from 70 alert rules (CPU per container, every single server error, any token spike, each retry) and acknowledges almost all of them without action. Last Tuesday the assistant's p95 sat at 8 s for 40 minutes and nobody noticed until customers complained. Which two changes should the observability review make? Select TWO.

- **A** Page on a small set of SLA alerts, p95 above 5 s or error rate above 1% sustained for 10 minutes, each with a named owner
- **B** Ask the on-call engineer to review every alert more carefully and to escalate anything that looks unusual to the team lead
- **C** Add an LLM agent that reads all 350 weekly alerts, groups them and pages the engineer only when it judges a pattern to be important
- **D** Keep the other signals as metrics and dashboard panels for investigation, not as pages
- **E** Alert when the five-minute mean latency exceeds 5 s, which is simpler to compute and far less noisy than a p95 alert

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9 Arjun Bose reviews how KAVI's first build reaches its systems. One permanent API key, never rotated, is shared by the TMS integration, the WMS integration and all three carrier connectors. The `process_refund` tool checks nothing itself; the system prompt says refunds of ₹5,000 or more need a human. Last week a carrier connector's log leaked the shared key, and the team could not tell which integration had made a series of WMS writes. Which three changes should Arjun make? Select THREE.

- **A** Move the ₹5,000 refund rule to the top of the system prompt, in capitals, with three worked examples
- **B** Enforce the ₹5,000 refund threshold in `process_refund`'s own code, routing ₹5,000 and above to `escalate_to_human`
- **C** Give each of the five integrations its own service account with scopes for its own system only
- **D** Keep one shared key, scoped to all five systems, but store it in the secrets manager and rotate it monthly, so there is one credential to guard
- **E** Replace the permanent key with short-lived OAuth tokens issued to each service account

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10 Pelican Courier's policy-answer route must meet p95 ≤ 4 s for the complete answer and keep answer accuracy of at least 90%. Today it retrieves the top 40 chunks, reranks them and answers with a mid-tier model: p95 4.6 s, accuracy 93.1%. Three trials were run on the same test set. Top-k cut from 40 to 20: p95 3.7 s, accuracy 92.8%. Reranker switched off: p95 3.1 s, accuracy 88.4%. Streaming switched on: first token at 0.9 s, complete answer p95 still 4.6 s. Which two statements belong in the configuration decision record? Select TWO.

- **A** To meet the 4 s p95 target, cut top-k from 40 to 20, bringing p95 from 4.6 s to 3.7 s at a cost of 0.3 points of accuracy
- **B** Switch streaming on, since a first token at 0.9 s puts the route comfortably inside the 4 s p95 promise without touching retrieval quality
- **C** Cut top-k and switch the reranker off together, which gives the most headroom under 4 s for the traffic growth expected next year
- **D** Reject switching the reranker off: it clears 4 s but drops accuracy to 88.4%, below the floor
- **E** Keep the current configuration for now and ask the team to watch latency closely for another month before moving any dial

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11 Pelican Courier in Kochi gives its rider-support agent three tools on a remote MCP server: `track_parcel`, `update_drop_address` and `waive_cod_charge`. To get a demo working, a developer pasted the server's admin token into the system prompt and told the model to pass it as a tool argument; the finance desk's nightly reconciliation job uses the same token. The security review wants two outcomes: the model never handles a credential, and the rider-support agent is unable to waive a cash-on-delivery charge even if a rider talks it into trying. Which two changes deliver both outcomes? Select TWO.

- **A** Make riders sign in with a one-time password checked in the server code, so every conversation is tied to a verified rider before any tool is called
- **B** Configure the agent's token in the MCP client, so the host attaches it to each request and it stays out of the conversation
- **C** Give the rider-support agent its own service account whose token carries only tracking and address scopes, checked in the server code before any tool runs
- **D** Place a second model in front of the agent that screens each rider message for persuasion attempts and blocks the suspicious ones before they arrive
- **E** Add a firm rule to the system prompt that the agent must refuse every waiver request and must not repeat the token back to a rider

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12 Rann Salt Works wants its plant supervisors to ask Claude about 60 safety data sheets and operating procedures, about 140,000 tokens in total, revised once a quarter. A consultant proposes a full retrieval pipeline: heading-aware chunks, contextual embeddings, BM25 and a reranker. The plant manager wants accurate answers, a modest monthly bill and no pipeline for the two-person IT team to maintain. About 900 questions arrive a day. Which two decisions fit? Select TWO.

- **A** Skip retrieval: put all 60 documents in the prompt as a fixed prefix and cache it, with each question placed after it
- **B** Summarise the documents to 20,000 tokens first, as 140,000 tokens exceeds what prompt caching accepts
- **C** Build the consultant's pipeline, since contextual embeddings with BM25 and reranking cut retrieval failures by 67% in published tests
- **D** Put each supervisor's question at the top of the prompt and the 60 documents after it, so the model reads the question first
- **E** Re-check the total size whenever documents are added, and plan a retrieval pipeline once the set nears 200,000 tokens

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13 Rann Salt Works connects its sales assistant to an ERP vendor's MCP server, which exposes 30 tools, from `read_stock` and `read_price_list` to `post_journal_entry` and `approve_vendor_payment`. The server supports OAuth scopes per tool, but the pilot requested the broad `erp:all` scope for convenience. The sales assistant needs only the two read tools. A penetration tester has shown that a crafted customer email can steer the assistant into calling any tool it is offered. Which two changes close the gap? Select TWO.

- **A** Pass every customer email through a separate classifier model that blocks the ones that look like injection before the assistant reads them
- **B** Add a system-prompt rule that the assistant must not call journal or payment tools
- **C** Keep the broad `erp:all` scope but rotate the token weekly through the secrets manager, so that a stolen token stays useful for only a few days
- **D** Request a token carrying only the two read scopes, so the server's own code refuses every other tool for this assistant
- **E** Filter the tool list the client sends with each request, so the model is offered only `read_stock` and `read_price_list`

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14 Alder Bank's compliance assistant answers questions from 900 procedure documents. Reviewers find two different faults. First, for some questions the right paragraph never appears among the 20 chunks passed to the model, though it exists in the corpus; the route's latency budget keeps that limit at 20. Second, after last month's procedure update the assistant sometimes quotes the superseded 2025 version of the sanctions-screening step alongside the current one, and states the old rule with confidence. Which two changes address these two faults? Select TWO.

- **A** Cut the 20 chunks passed to the model to the top 5 by similarity, which raises the precision of what the model reads
- **B** Retrieve a broader candidate set, about 150 chunks, from hybrid keyword and embedding search, rerank it and pass the top 20
- **C** Raise the number of chunks passed to the model from 20 to 60, so that both the missing paragraphs and the current versions are more likely to be included
- **D** Label every chunk with its document version and drop superseded versions from the index when a procedure is updated
- **E** Tell the model in the system prompt to prefer the newest version whenever two retrieved passages on the same step disagree

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15 Alder Bank in Dublin runs a complaints-handling assistant over 3,200 internal procedure documents, searched by embeddings alone with the top 20 chunks passed to the model. Many chunks read like 'Refer the case to the second-line team within five working days', and the complaint type they belong to appears only in the document's title. The assistant often quotes a step from the wrong procedure. The team's target is to cut top-20 retrieval failures by about two-thirds, the best result in the published contextual-retrieval tests. Which three changes does that target require? Select THREE.

- **A** Index the same context-prefixed chunks in a BM25 keyword index and fuse its scores with the embedding scores
- **B** Retrieve about 150 candidates, rerank them, and pass the top 20 to the model
- **C** Prepend a short context naming the document, section and complaint type to each chunk before it is embedded
- **D** Attach the document title to each chunk only after retrieval, just before the chunks are sent to the model, so the index stays unchanged
- **E** Double the chunk size so each chunk carries enough text to name its complaint type

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16 Pelican Courier in Kochi traces every request of its delivery-exception assistant, about 1.2 million a day, and the observability bill has tripled. Two causes stand out: full traces are stored for every routine success, and the parcel ID was added as a label on the latency and token metrics, creating millions of series. The operations head still needs to investigate every failed or timed-out request end to end. Which two changes cut the bill without losing that ability? Select TWO.

- **A** Remove the parcel ID from metric labels and record it in logs and trace attributes, keeping labels to bounded values such as stage
- **B** Replace tracing with a p95 latency metric per stage, since a per-stage percentile already shows where slow requests spend time
- **C** Sample 5% of all requests uniformly at random, errors included, which cuts the trace volume by 95% in a single change
- **D** Keep a trace for every error and timeout, and sample routine successful requests at a small fixed rate
- **E** Send traces to a second observability vendor as well, so that each vendor stores half the volume at a lower contract tier

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17 Godwit Insurance opens a policy assistant to its broker firms. Brokers sign in through the insurer's single sign-on, and the assistant's `get_policy` tool reads policies through a service account that can see every policy on the book. Last week a broker from one firm asked about a policy number that belongs to a rival firm's client and received the full schedule. The audit log shows only the calls that succeeded. The audit committee wants refused requests to be visible as well. Which two changes close these gaps? Select TWO.

- **A** Tell the assistant in its system prompt to answer only about policies held by clients of the broker's own firm
- **B** Add multi-factor authentication to the broker sign-in, so that only genuine brokers can reach the assistant and ask about policies
- **C** Write denied requests to the audit log, with broker, policy number and reason, alongside the granted ones
- **D** Give the model the broker's sign-on token as a tool argument, so that a check in code can confirm the caller on every request it serves
- **E** Have the host pass the signed-in broker's firm to the tool outside the conversation, and check in code that the policy belongs to that firm before reading

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18 Rann Salt Works is configuring three Claude workloads, each at the lowest cost that meets its bar. Every night about 12,000 brine-lab readings are summarised into reports that nobody reads until the Monday review. A buyer-chat assistant must show its first words within 1.5 s at p95; its full replies take about 6 s, and a streamed trial showed first words at p95 0.9 s. A salt-grade classifier must reach at least 92% accuracy on the test set: the smallest model tier scores 93.4% at p95 0.6 s, a mid-tier model 96.1% at p95 1.4 s. Which three configuration decisions are justified? Select THREE.

- **A** Turn on streaming for the buyer chat so its first words appear within the promise
- **B** Send the nightly lab summaries through the Message Batches API at half the price, since no one reads them before Monday
- **C** Run the grade classifier on the smallest model tier, which clears the 92% bar at 93.4% with less cost and latency
- **D** Send the buyer chat through the Message Batches API as well, halving its cost
- **E** Run the grade classifier on the mid-tier model to be safe, since 96.1% leaves a wider margin above the 92% bar for unusual grades

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19 Alder Bank's financial-crime orchestrator delegates to three subagents: one researches a customer's history, one summarises bank statements and one drafts the case letter. Each subagent receives all 28 tools, about 6,200 tokens of schemas, on every call. The logs show three near-identical read tools, `get_customer`, `fetch_client` and `customer_profile`, chosen almost at random, and that `file_suspicious_activity_report` is used in only 0.2% of cases, though a missed filing is a regulatory breach. Which three changes should the review recommend? Select THREE.

- **A** Add a tool-routing subagent that reads each request and tells the other three which of the customer tools to call
- **B** Give each subagent only the tools its own job needs instead of all 28
- **C** Remove every tool used in fewer than 1% of cases, because the usage logs show those schemas are dead weight on every call
- **D** Keep `file_suspicious_activity_report` in the trimmed tool set despite its 0.2% usage, because a missed filing is a breach
- **E** Merge the three lookalike customer-read tools into one tool with a sharp description of what it returns

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20 Godwit Insurance is building a claims-handler assistant over 1,800 policy wordings. Each wording is organised under numbered headings (Cover, Exclusions, Conditions) and carries benefit tables that list sub-limits by plan. The pilot cut every document into fixed 400-token windows. Handlers report two faults: quoted exclusion clauses stop mid-sentence, and sub-limit figures come back attached to the wrong plan because the table rows landed in a chunk without their header row. Which two changes, taken together, fix both faults? Select TWO.

- **A** Chunk each wording along its numbered headings and clauses, with a small overlap between neighbouring chunks
- **B** Re-embed the corpus with a larger embedding model, which captures the meaning of partial clauses and headerless table rows more precisely
- **C** Add a reranker over the top 150 candidates so the best-matching chunk rises to the top
- **D** Shrink the fixed windows from 400 to 150 tokens so that each chunk holds a single idea and more chunks fit into the top 20
- **E** Keep each benefit table in one chunk together with its header row

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21 Godwit Insurance's claims assistant receives three kinds of question: 'what is the status of claim GW-CL-448812?', 'how many motor claims above ₹2,00,000 were reopened in September?' and 'does the home policy cover damage from a slowly leaking pipe?'. The claims table, the claim-notes archive and 1,800 policy wordings are all available. The current build sends every question through semantic search over the notes and wordings. Which three routing decisions should the redesign adopt? Select THREE.

- **A** Answer the claim-status question with semantic search over the claim notes, which describe each claim's status
- **B** Answer the reopened-claims question by retrieving the top 150 claim notes and asking the model to count the September reopenings in them
- **C** Answer the reopened-claims question with a SQL-style count over the claims table filtered by type, amount and month
- **D** Send the claim-status question to a structured lookup on the claims table using the claim number
- **E** Answer the cover question with hybrid retrieval over the policy wordings, fusing keyword and embedding scores

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22 KAVI promises a first response within 2 s at p95. The operations dashboard shows a mean latency of 310 ms and has been green all month, yet dispatchers say some tickets hang. Arjun Bose adds a latency histogram: p95 is 2,900 ms. He then follows one slow ticket's end-to-end trace, which totals 4,100 ms. Meera Nair asks what the team learned and what the dashboard should change. Which two statements are correct? Select TWO.

- **A** The SLA is met, since the mean of 310 ms sits far below 2 s and a single ticket at 4,100 ms is an outlier rather than a trend
- **B** The fix is to label the latency metric with the ticket ID, so each slow ticket shows up
- **C** The slow ticket's 4,100 ms trace shows which stage its time went to, which the histogram cannot
- **D** The SLA is breached: p95 is 2,900 ms against a 2,000 ms promise, so the dashboard should chart and alert on p95
- **E** The p95 histogram shows the slow stage, so the trace is unnecessary and per-request tracing can be switched off to save storage

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23 Pelican Courier's hub staff in Kochi use a Claude assistant to troubleshoot handheld scanners. It searches, by embeddings alone, the scanner manual and an export of the riders' informal chat group, which nobody reviews. Two faults appear. Queries quoting a fault code such as E-417 often return the page for E-471. Some answers repeat a chat-group tip, 'pull the battery during an upload', that the manual forbids. Symptom descriptions such as 'the screen goes dark in sunlight' are answered well. Which three decisions should the redesign adopt? Select THREE.

- **A** Remove the unreviewed chat-group export from the index that the assistant quotes as guidance
- **B** Keep embedding search for symptom descriptions, which seldom share exact words with the manual
- **C** Treat the lookalike-code fault as low recall and raise top-k from 10 to 50, so that the right page is far more likely to be in the context
- **D** Add a second model that checks every answer against the manual and rewrites any step that conflicts with it before the answer is shown
- **E** Add BM25 keyword matching and weight it heavily when a query contains a fault code, so the exact code's page outranks lookalikes

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24 Godwit Insurance is planning three integrations. First, the underwriting team's own Python job calls one fixed reinsurance-rate endpoint each night and passes the figures to Claude in a set template; no choice of tool is involved. Second, eleven claims tools (policy lookup, document fetch, fraud score and others) must be usable from Claude Code, an internal chat assistant and an Agent SDK claims agent. Third, a partner loss adjuster runs its own autonomous agent with its own goals and tools, and Godwit's claims agent must hand it a case and receive an assessment. Which two mechanism choices are right? Select TWO.

- **A** Expose the eleven claims tools through one MCP server that all three clients connect to
- **B** Call the reinsurance-rate endpoint directly from the job's own code
- **C** Expose the eleven claims tools as MCP resources, so that the model in each client can invoke them whenever a claim needs an action
- **D** Expose the partner adjuster's internal steps as tools on Godwit's MCP server, so that Godwit's claims agent can drive each step itself
- **E** Wrap the nightly rate call in an MCP server as well, for one standard connector pattern

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25 Rann Salt Works runs two Claude agents. The plant agent has 120 tools across maintenance, inventory, quality and shipping; any one task uses two or three, and their schemas total about 48,000 tokens. The weighbridge agent has three tools used on every call, schemas 640 tokens, then a stable 900-token system prompt; its only cache breakpoint sits on the last tool, and its model's minimum cacheable prefix is 1,024 tokens. Its developer says caching 'does nothing'. Which two changes are right? Select TWO.

- **A** Mark the weighbridge agent's three tools with `defer_loading: true` as well, so that both agents follow the same discovery pattern
- **B** Cache the plant agent's full 48,000 tokens of tool schemas instead of deferring them, since a cache read costs only a fraction of normal input
- **C** Move the weighbridge agent's cache breakpoint to the end of the system prompt, so the cached prefix becomes 1,540 tokens
- **D** Give the plant agent the tool search tool and mark most of its 120 tools with `defer_loading: true`, keeping a few frequent tools loaded
- **E** Raise the weighbridge agent's `max_tokens` setting to 1,024, so that each request is large enough to clear the minimum cacheable size

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26 Alder Bank in Dublin runs a three-stage Claude pipeline for card-dispute intake (classify, retrieve policy, draft the letter) at about 250,000 requests a day. The service level is p95 ≤ 3 s end to end. The operations dashboard shows a mean latency of 0.8 s and stays green, yet customers complain of long waits and some requests time out. An engineer proposes adding the customer ID as a label on the latency metric so slow customers can be found. Which three moves give the team a trustworthy view of the SLA and of where slow requests spend their time? Select THREE.

- **A** Chart and alert on p95 and p99 end-to-end latency against the 3 s promise instead of on the mean
- **B** Trace a uniform 1% sample of all requests to keep trace storage flat at 250,000 requests a day
- **C** Alert on every metric of every stage at p50, p95 and p99, so that no regression anywhere in the pipeline can slip past unnoticed
- **D** Carry one trace ID through all three stages so that a slow request's spans show which stage took the time
- **E** Record the customer ID in logs and trace attributes, not as a metric label

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27 Godwit Insurance's policy assistant answers questions over the wordings of its home, contents, landlord and travel products. Its retrieval eval tracks only recall@20, which stands at 97%: the right clause is almost always among the 20 chunks passed to the model. Yet answers often blend in limits from neighbouring products, and a review of 200 answers finds that on average only 3 of the 20 chunks are relevant to the question. Which two changes should the team make? Select TWO.

- **A** Raise top-k from 20 to 40 so that recall climbs from 97% toward 100% and the right clause is missed less often
- **B** Add a precision measure, the share of passed chunks that are relevant, to the retrieval eval
- **C** Rerank the retrieved chunks and pass the model only the top few, accepting a small loss of recall for much higher precision
- **D** Add a second retrieval round in which an agent rewrites the question and searches again whenever the first answer looks uncertain
- **E** Tell the model in its system prompt to use only chunks about the product named in the question and to ignore all the rest

28 Godwit Insurance's claims-triage agent must return its triage decision within 6 s at p95 and keep triage accuracy at or above 92%. Today p95 is 7.8 s and accuracy 95%. For each claim the agent calls three independent lookups one after another: policy 1.1 s, claims history 1.3 s, fraud score 1.6 s. Two trials were run. Issuing the three lookups as parallel tool calls: p95 5.4 s, accuracy unchanged. Cutting effort from high to low: p95 5.6 s, accuracy 90.8%. Which two statements belong in the decision record? Select TWO.

- **A** Turn on streaming instead, since it shortens the time the claims team waits and leaves the lookups and the model untouched
- **B** Reject cutting effort to low: it clears 6 s at 5.6 s, but its 90.8% accuracy falls below the 92% bar
- **C** Move each lookup into its own subagent under an orchestrator, so that the three lookups run in parallel in separate contexts and p95 falls
- **D** The parallel calls save 2.4 s because each lookup then runs faster, with less contention for the claims database
- **E** To meet the 6 s p95 target, issue the three lookups as parallel tool calls, cutting p95 from 7.8 s to 5.4 s with no loss of accuracy

29 Pelican Courier is building a staff assistant over its rate cards, service terms and operations circulars: about 2,600 documents, roughly 7.5 million tokens. Rate cards are tables of weight bands by delivery zone; circulars are heading-structured. About 40 documents change each day, and staff must never be quoted a rate that has been withdrawn. Which three decisions belong in the pipeline design? Select THREE.

- **A** Keep each rate-card table, or each slice of it, together with its header row of zones and weight bands
- **B** Index every rate-card row as its own chunk, for the highest possible retrieval precision
- **C** Re-index the changed documents every day, label chunks with version and effective date, and drop withdrawn versions
- **D** Build a retrieval pipeline, since 7.5 million tokens is far too large to send whole in a cached prompt
- **E** Put all the documents into one cached prompt, since cache reads cost a small fraction of normal input and remove retrieval errors entirely

30 Rann Salt Works gives its sales desk a Claude assistant. Every question goes through one vector index built over product sheets, buyer contracts and exports of the dispatch-order table. Two kinds of question fail: 'where is dispatch order RSW-55120?' returns a passage about a different order, and 'what is the moisture limit for grade G7-FF?' returns the sheet for grade G7-F. Questions such as 'why would a buyer reject caked salt?' work well. Which two changes fix the failing questions without breaking the ones that work? Select TWO.

- **A** Add BM25 keyword search beside the embeddings and fuse the two scores, so exact grade codes outrank near-miss codes
- **B** Replace the vector index with keyword search alone, since exact order numbers and grade codes are what keeps failing
- **C** Send questions that carry a dispatch-order number to a structured lookup on the dispatch-order table, with no retrieval step
- **D** Put an agent in front that chooses among five retrieval tools for each question and re-plans whenever the first results look weak
- **E** Re-embed everything with a larger embedding model trained on industrial vocabulary, so codes like G7-FF and G7-F get clearly separate vectors

Stop. Pencil down at 55 minutes. Then turn the page.

✂ FOLD HERE · SEALED KEY ✂

EVERY LETTER MUST MATCH

Key

1 · 3.1 **A+C**	2 · 3.8 **B+D**	3 · 3.4 **C+D+E**	4 · 3.5 **B+E**	5 · 3.7 **A+C+E**	6 · 3.2 **A+B+D**
7 · 3.8 **B+C+E**	8 · 3.4 **A+D**	9 · 3.2 **B+C+E**	10 · 3.3 **A+D**	11 · 3.2 **B+C**	12 · 3.5 **A+E**
13 · 3.2 **D+E**	14 · 3.6 **B+D**	15 · 3.5 **A+B+C**	16 · 3.4 **A+D**	17 · 3.2 **C+E**	18 · 3.3 **A+B+C**
19 · 3.1 **B+D+E**	20 · 3.5 **A+E**	21 · 3.6 **C+D+E**	22 · 3.4 **C+D**	23 · 3.6 **A+B+E**	24 · 3.7 **A+B**
25 · 3.8 **C+D**	26 · 3.4 **A+D+E**	27 · 3.6 **B+C**	28 · 3.3 **B+E**	29 · 3.5 **A+C+D**	30 · 3.6 **A+C**

Tally by objective · three or more misses on one objective sends you to that Gym station

Objective	Items	Your misses	O	U	C
3.1 Capability bloat	1, 19				
3.2 Authentication & authorization	6, 9, 11, 13, 17				
3.3 Accuracy–latency trade-offs	10, 18, 28				
3.4 Observability at scale	3, 8, 16, 22, 26				
3.5 RAG pipeline: chunking & indexing	4, 12, 15, 20, 29				
3.6 Retrieval strategy	14, 21, 23, 27, 30				
3.7 Connection protocols	5, 24				
3.8 Progressive vs monolithic context	2, 7, 25				

BOTH OR ALL THREE CORRECT OPTIONS, THE TELL, AND WHY EACH WRONG ONE TEMPTS

Explanations

1 **Answer A + C** obj 3.1 · Capability bloat · select 2 # number decides

The tell fires on only a small share of cases but is the path for anything KAVI must not settle alone

A ✓ **2,314** − **811** = **1,503** tokens per call; **1,503 × 40,000** = **60,120,000** tokens a day of schema that no routine call uses.

C ✓ Trim by usage AND consequence: a rarely used tool such as an escalation path stays if missing it is costly.

B **OE** A whole extra agent to manage nine tools; trimming by usage and consequence does it without a new stage.

D **VG** Tool schemas are input tokens sent with each request; the trim cuts input cost and selection confusion, not reply length.

E **SD** A sign with no lock: all **2,314** tokens of schema still ride on every call whatever the prompt says.

↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.1 · Atlas A4 ; Dock Walk Station 5 ; Dock Gym station 3.1

2 **Answer B + D** obj 3.8 · Progressive vs monolithic context · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head · ↔ leans on D2

The tell investigators need that ledger in view for the whole session

B ✓ Clearing removes the raw results; notes written to memory survive outside the context for the final report.

D ✓ Server-side context editing clears stale tool results; excluding the ledger keeps the one result needed all session.

A **SD** A sign: all the old results stay in the context and keep costing tokens on every call.

C **CM** The ledger came from the first call; once the ~**100k** trigger fires, defaults keep only the **3** most recent tool uses and clear it.

E **TR** Spends more of the cost that is already climbing, and a fuller context makes the mixing-up worse.

↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.8 · Atlas A7 ; Dock Walk Station 8 ; Dock Gym station 3.8

3 **Answer C + D + E** obj 3.4 · Observability at scale · select 3 # number decides · ↔ leans on D4

The tell nobody can say which stage caused the rise

C ✓ Metrics show which stage costs more on average; a trace with per-span tokens shows why one exception was expensive, and holds its ID safely.

D ✓ One actionable alert tied to the ceiling Finance set; it fires on the number that matters, with an owner.

E ✓ Per-stage token and cost metrics with bounded labels show where the **₹0.70** overrun comes from.

A **CM** Ignores scale: **3,00,000** unbounded IDs a month as labels explode cardinality; IDs belong in logs and traces.

B **SD** No per-stage signal and no threshold: the next overrun is again found a month late with no stage named.

↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.4 · Atlas A6 ; Dock Walk Station 4 ; Dock Gym station 3.4

4 **Answer B + E** obj 3.5 · RAG pipeline: chunking & indexing · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head

The tell because that procedure had been cut across two chunks

B ✓ Heading-aware chunks keep §**4** whole; the overlap carries context across any remaining boundary, so the re-filing steps are retrieved together.

E ✓ Weekly updates need a weekly re-index; version labels and dropping stale chunks stop last week's steps being quoted.

A **OE** An extra stage that fixes neither fault: no chunk holds all of §**4,** and last week's chunks are still in the index.

C **CM** Addresses neither fault: §**4** was cut across chunks and the stale steps came from an old index, not from language.

D **VG** Reranking orders chunks; no chunk held the whole §**4** procedure to rise. The chunking is the fault.

↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.5 · Atlas A2 ; Dock Walk Station 1 ; Dock Gym station 3.5

5 **Answer A + C + E** obj 3.7 · Connection protocols · select 3 ⇄ head-to-head
The tell a daily tide-and-weather bulletin that the application attaches to each conversation
A ✓ Tools are model-invoked actions; the model decides when a question needs a reading and which pond.
C ✓ Prompts are user-invoked templates; a review a supervisor starts from a menu is exactly that.
E ✓ Remote clients need the remote transport, and a remote server needs real authentication.
B **CM** Ignores that the clients are remote: stdio is a local process on the same machine as its client.
D **VG** Application-provided data is a resource; a prompt is a template the user chooses to invoke.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.7 · Atlas A4 ; Dock Walk Station 7 ; Dock Gym station 3.7

6 **Answer A + B + D** obj 3.2 · Authentication & authorization · select 3 ⇄ head-to-head
The tell only the collections team may use `freeze_card`
A ✓ One service account per integration: the server stops borrowing a person's login, which would break or linger when she leaves.
B ✓ Authorization in code, per tool, is the lock that keeps `freeze_card` to the collections team.
D ✓ A remote Streamable HTTP server needs real authentication; per-team, short-lived tokens replace the developer's inherited login.
C **OP** Network reach is not identity: every device inside could call every tool, `freeze_card` included.
E **CM** Ignores the transport change: stdio inherited one person's login on one machine; a shared remote server needs its own authentication.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.2 · Atlas A5 ; Dock Walk Station 3 ; Dock Gym station 3.2

7 **Answer B + C + E** obj 3.8 · Progressive vs monolithic context · select 3 # number decides
The tell identical on every call and used by every case
B ✓ Small, stable and always used: monolithic plus caching wins, and a fetch step would add a round trip every case needs anyway.
C ✓ Large, changing, rarely used content is exactly where progressive discovery wins: the map first, the territory on demand.
E ✓ **9 × 25 + 260 + 20 × 180 + 120 = 225 + 260 + 3,600 + 120 = 4,205**; **362,460 ÷ 4,205 ≈ 86**.
A **CM** Even at **0.025×**, the lowest read rate, that is about **9,061** tokens' worth a call, above **4,205**; weekly SOP edits also rewrite the prefix.
D **OE** Adds a fetch to every call for content every case uses; uniformity is not a reason to pay a round trip.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.8 · Atlas A7 ; Dock Walk Station 8 ; Dock Gym station 3.8

8 **Answer A + D** obj 3.4 · Observability at scale · select 2 # number decides · ⇄ head-to-head
The tell acknowledges almost all of them without action
A ✓ Alerts should be few, tied to the SLA and actionable; these two would have paged within minutes of last Tuesday's breach.
D ✓ The signals still help diagnose a breach; demoting them from pages ends the noise that trained the engineer to ignore alerts.
B **SD** No threshold, no number: **350** alerts a week stay unreadable, and the breach still hides among them.
C **OE** A new agent to filter noise that should not be generated; two SLA alerts fix it without a model.
E **VG** The SLA is about the tail; a p95 of **8 s** can sit beside a mean well under **5 s**, so this alert stays silent.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.4 · Atlas A6 ; Dock Walk Station 4 ; Dock Gym station 3.4

9 **Answer B + C + E** obj 3.2 · Authentication & authorization · select 3 ↔ leans on D5 · ⇄ head-to-head
The tell the team could not tell which integration had made a series of WMS writes
B ✓ A rule in the prompt is a sign; a check in the tool's code is a lock that holds whatever the model is persuaded to try.
C ✓ Separate service accounts per integration mean a leak exposes one door, and every write is traceable to the integration that made it.
E ✓ Short-lived tokens limit how long a leaked credential is useful; a permanent key works until someone notices and revokes it.
A **SD** A louder sign is still a sign; nothing in code stops a large refund the model is talked into.
D **OP** One key for five doors again: the next leak opens all of them and writes stay unattributable.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.2 · Atlas A5 ; Dock Walk Station 3 ; Dock Gym station 3.2

10 **Answer A + D** obj 3.3 · Accuracy–latency trade-offs · select 2 # number decides · ⇄ head-to-head
The tell must meet p95 ≤ 4 s for the complete answer and keep answer accuracy of at least 90%
A ✓ Constraint, dial, direction and number in one line: **3.7 s** clears **4 s**, and **92.8%** (**93.1** − **0.3**) stays above the **90%** floor.
D ✓ Only one of the two latency fixes clears both constraints; a rejected alternative with its number is part of a sound record.
B **VG** Streaming cuts time to first token, not total time; the complete-answer p95 is still **4.6 s**.
C **TR** Spends the accuracy the stem fixed: without the reranker accuracy falls below **90%** to buy headroom nobody asked for.
E **SD** The trials already show a dial that clears both bars; watching closely adds no number, owner or gate.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.3 · Atlas A1 ; Dock Walk Station 6 ; Dock Gym station 3.3

11 **Answer B + C** obj 3.2 · Authentication & authorization · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head · ↔ leans on D5
The tell the rider-support agent is unable to waive a cash-on-delivery charge even if a rider talks it into trying
B ✓ Credentials belong to the host, not the model: attached outside the context, the token cannot be read out, leaked or chosen by the model.
C ✓ A separate account with scopes checked in code is the lock: `waive_cod_charge` is refused for this caller however persuasive the rider is.
A **VG** That authenticates the rider; the agent's token can still waive charges, so authorization is unchanged.
D **OE** Adds a stage that guesses at intent; the shared admin token still permits waivers, so nothing is locked.
E **SD** A sign, not a lock: a persuasive rider can talk past it, and the token is still in the model's context.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.2 · Atlas A5 ; Dock Walk Station 3 ; Dock Gym station 3.2

12 **Answer A + E** obj 3.5 · RAG pipeline: chunking & indexing · select 2 # number decides · ↔ leans on D2
The tell about 140,000 tokens in total, revised once a quarter
A ✓ Under about **200k** tokens, the whole knowledge base fits; caching the static prefix makes **900** daily questions cheap, with no index to maintain.
E ✓ The skip-RAG choice rests on the ~**200k** threshold; a plain size check keeps the decision honest as the library grows.
B **VG** Mistakes the cache minimum for a maximum; **140,000** tokens caches fine, and summaries drop exact safety limits.
C **OE** A true figure, but for a corpus that must be retrieved from; **140,000** tokens fits whole and needs no pipeline.
D **TR** A changing question first breaks the cached prefix on every call, spending the modest bill the manager asked for.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.5 · Atlas A1 ; Dock Walk Station 1 ; Dock Gym station 3.5

13 **Answer D + E** obj 3.2 · Authentication & authorization · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head · ↔ leans on D5
The tell a crafted customer email can steer the assistant into calling any tool it is offered
D ✓ Least privilege at the door: whoever holds a token holds every tool it opens, so the token should open only two.
E ✓ The tester showed it calls any tool it is offered; a tool filtered out of the request is never offered, so no email can steer the model to it.
A **OE** Adds a stage that guesses at intent; the next email it misses still meets a token that opens all **30** tools.
B **SD** A sign, not a lock: the tester has already shown that a crafted email steers the model past instructions.
C **VG** Rotation is authentication hygiene; the assistant can still call all **30** tools, so authorization is unchanged.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.2 · Atlas A5 ; Dock Walk Station 3 ; Dock Gym station 3.2

14 **Answer B + D** obj 3.6 · Retrieval strategy · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head
The tell the route's latency budget keeps that limit at 20
B ✓ The first fault is recall: the right chunk never made it in. Retrieving broadly and reranking lifts recall without flooding the context.
D ✓ The second fault is context poisoning by stale chunks; version labels and removing old versions stop them reaching the prompt.
A **VG** Precision is not the first fault: the right chunk was not in the **20,** and five fewer makes recall worse.
C **TR** Breaks the latency budget that holds the limit at **20,** floods the context, and keeps the stale **2025** chunks in play.
E **SD** A sign: stale chunks still reach the prompt, and many chunks carry no visible date for the model to compare.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.6 · Atlas A3 ; Dock Walk Station 2 ; Dock Gym station 3.6

15 **Answer A + B + C** obj 3.5 · RAG pipeline: chunking & indexing · select 3 # number decides · ▲ the bigger option is right
The tell cut top-20 retrieval failures by about two-thirds
A ✓ Contextual BM25 adds exact-term matching on the same enriched text; together with contextual embeddings it reached a **49%** cut.
B ✓ Reranking the broad candidate set took the published cut to **67%**, about two-thirds; the target needs this third stage.
C ✓ Contextual embeddings put the missing title information into every chunk's vector; alone this cut failures by **35%** in the published tests.
D **VG** Context must be added before indexing; added afterwards it helps the reader but the wrong chunks were already retrieved.
E **CM** Ignores that the type appears only in the title; bigger chunks rarely reach it and dilute every chunk's precision.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.5 · Atlas A1 ; Dock Walk Station 1 ; Dock Gym station 3.5

16 **Answer A + D** obj 3.4 · Observability at scale · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head
The tell needs to investigate every failed or timed-out request end to end
A ✓ Unbounded IDs as labels cause the cardinality explosion; in logs and traces the ID stays searchable without new series.
D ✓ Sampling at scale is right as long as **100%** of errors are kept; every failed request stays traceable end to end.
B **VG** A metric aggregates many requests; only a trace shows where the time went for one failed request.
C **SF** Silently drops **95%** of failed requests, the very ones the operations head must investigate.
E **OE** Adds a system while keeping both causes: the same traces and the same exploding labels.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.4 · Atlas A6 ; Dock Walk Station 4 ; Dock Gym station 3.4

17 **Answer C + E** obj 3.2 · Authentication & authorization · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head · ↔ leans on D5
The tell a service account that can see every policy on the book
C ✓ The committee asked to see refusals; an audit log that records only grants hides exactly the probing it needs to see.
E ✓ The gap is authorization: an all-book account with no per-request check. A check in code against the caller's firm is the lock.
A **SD** A sign, not a lock: the service account still reads every policy, and a cleverly worded question gets past the sentence.
B **VG** Stronger authentication proves who the broker is; the broker in the incident was genuine. What they may read is unchanged.
D **OP** Hands a credential to the model, which may leak or misuse it; identity should travel outside the conversation.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.2 · Atlas A5 ; Dock Walk Station 3 ; Dock Gym station 3.2

18 **Answer A + B + C** obj 3.3 · Accuracy–latency trade-offs · select 3 # number decides · ⇄ head-to-head
The tell each at the lowest cost that meets its bar
A ✓ The promise is about first words, not the full **6 s** reply; streaming cuts time to first token, which is exactly the dial.
B ✓ Work that can wait is what batch is for: **50%** cheaper, and most batches finish well inside the time before anyone reads the reports.
C ✓ Both tiers clear **92%**; the tie-break is the cheaper, faster one, and **93.4%** at **0.6 s** clears the bar.
D **CM** Ignores the **1.5 s** first-words promise: a live chat cannot wait for a batch, however cheap.
E **TR** Spends the cost the stem fixed: once both tiers clear the bar, extra margin is not what was asked for.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.3 · Atlas A1 ; Dock Walk Station 6 ; Dock Gym station 3.3

19 **Answer B + D + E** obj 3.1 · Capability bloat · select 3 ⇄ head-to-head · # number decides · ↔ leans on D1
The tell though a missed filing is a regulatory breach
B ✓ Subagents get only the tools their job needs; every extra schema costs tokens on each call and adds a wrong-wrench risk.
D ✓ Trim by usage AND consequence: a rarely used tool stays when missing it is costly.
E ✓ Lookalikes confuse selection; one tool with a sharp description removes the coin toss.
A **OE** A fourth agent to paper over three lookalikes; merging them into one sharp tool removes the problem.
C **CM** Ignores consequence: the **1%** rule removes the filing tool, used in **0.2%** of cases, whose absence is a regulatory breach.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.1 · Atlas A4 ; Dock Walk Station 5 ; Dock Gym station 3.1

20 **Answer A + E** obj 3.5 · RAG pipeline: chunking & indexing · select 2
The tell the table rows landed in a chunk without their header row
A ✓ Heading-aware chunks follow the document's own structure, so a clause stays whole; the overlap carries context across any boundary that remains.
E ✓ A table row means nothing without its header; keeping them together tells the model which plan each sub-limit belongs to.
B **VG** Fixes the embedding when the fault is the chunk: a better vector of a broken chunk is still a broken chunk.
C **OE** Reranking orders chunks; it cannot restore a header row that was never in the chunk.
D **CM** Ignores the numbered headings: smaller length-based windows split clauses and tables more often, not less.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.5 · Atlas A2 ; Dock Walk Station 1 ; Dock Gym station 3.5

21 **Answer C + D + E** obj 3.6 · Retrieval strategy · select 3
The tell how many motor claims above ₹2,00,000 were reopened in September
C ✓ A count is a question about rows; retrieval returns a handful of passages and cannot count a table.
D ✓ An ID is an exact key: a structured query returns the one right row with no retrieval step.
E ✓ A policy question is a passage question; hybrid search catches both exact clause terms and paraphrases such as 'slowly leaking'.
A **CM** Ignores that the question carries an exact ID; similarity search can return a near-neighbour claim's notes.
B **VG** Treats recall of passages as a count; **150** notes are a sample, so the number is guessed, not computed.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.6 · Atlas A3 ; Dock Walk Station 2 ; Dock Gym station 3.6

22 **Answer C + D** obj 3.4 · Observability at scale · select 2 # number decides · ↔ leans on D6
The tell p95 is 2,900 ms
C ✓ A trace is the record for ONE request, with spans per stage; it names the stage that took the **4,100 ms**.
D ✓ SLAs are promises about tails; **2,900 ms** > **2,000 ms**, and a **310 ms** mean hid it.
A **VG** Confuses mean with p95: the promise is about the tail, and the tail sits at **2,900 ms**.
B **CM** Ticket IDs are unbounded; as metric labels they explode cardinality. IDs go in logs and traces.
E **SF** A histogram shows that the tail is slow, not where; switching tracing off loses the slow ticket's story.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.4 · Atlas A6 ; Dock Walk Station 4 ; Dock Gym station 3.4

23 **Answer A + B + E** obj 3.6 · Retrieval strategy · select 3 ⇄ head-to-head
The tell an export of the riders' informal chat group, which nobody reviews
A ✓ The forbidden tip is context poisoning: unvetted text injected and trusted. Taking it out of the index stops it at the source.
B ✓ Symptoms are paraphrase; semantic search already handles them well, so the redesign keeps it rather than replacing it.
E ✓ Exact codes are keyword territory: embeddings place E-417 and E-471 close together, while keyword matching tells them apart.
C **VG** The fault is precision, a lookalike outranking the right page; more chunks bring more lookalikes, not fewer.
D **OE** Adds a stage downstream while the poisoned source stays in the index and keeps being retrieved.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.6 · Atlas A3 ; Dock Walk Station 2 ; Dock Gym station 3.6

24 **Answer A + B** obj 3.7 · Connection protocols · select 2 ▲ the bigger option is right · ⇄ head-to-head
The tell no choice of tool is involved
A ✓ Many tools reused by several clients is where MCP pays off: write the server once and every MCP client uses it.
B ✓ One fixed, stable call from your own code needs no model choice and no connector; a direct API call is the simple, right tool.
C **VG** Resources are application-provided data; model-invoked actions are tools.
D **CM** Ignores that the partner's agent owns its own goals and tools; that is an agent-to-agent hand-off, not a tool list.
E **OE** A server for one fixed call that no model chooses; consistency is not a reason to add a component.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.7 · Atlas A4 ; Dock Walk Station 7 ; Dock Gym station 3.7

25 **Answer C + D** obj 3.8 · Progressive vs monolithic context · select 2 # number decides · ↔ leans on D2
The tell any one task uses two or three
C ✓ **640** tokens is below the **1,024** minimum, so nothing was cached, silently; tools plus system prompt, **640** + **900** = **1,540,** clears it.
D ✓ Large set, few used per task: the API-native catalogue loads only the tools a task searches for instead of **48,000** tokens every call.
A **OE** Three small, always-used tools are cheaper sent whole; deferring them adds a search step every call needs.
B **CM** Cheaper per token, but all **120** schemas still fill every context and add wrong-wrench risk; a large, rarely used set suits discovery.
E **VG** `max_tokens` caps the output; the minimum applies to the cached input prefix, which stays at **640** tokens.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.8 · Atlas A7 ; Dock Walk Station 8 ; Dock Gym station 3.8

26 **Answer A + D + E** obj 3.4 · Observability at scale · select 3 # number decides
The tell yet customers complain of long waits and some requests time out
A ✓ The SLA is a promise about the tail; a **0.8 s** mean can sit beside a p95 well above **3 s**, so the percentile is the number to watch.
D ✓ A trace with spans per stage answers where the time went for one request, which no aggregate metric can.
E ✓ Customer IDs are unbounded; as metric labels they explode cardinality. In logs and traces they stay searchable at no such cost.
B **SF** Throws away **99%** of the timed-out requests customers complain about; sample routine traces but keep every error.
C **OE** Dozens of alerts not tied to the SLA bury the one that matters; alerts should be few and actionable.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.4 · Atlas A6 ; Dock Walk Station 4 ; Dock Gym station 3.4

27 **Answer B + C** obj 3.6 · Retrieval strategy · select 2 # number decides · ⇄ head-to-head
The tell the right clause is almost always among the 20 chunks passed to the model
B ✓ An eval that tracks only recall shows **97%** and hides the fault; measuring precision makes it visible and the fix checkable.
C ✓ The fault is precision, **3** of **20** relevant (**15%**); reranking and passing fewer chunks removes the neighbouring-product noise.
A **TR** Buys recall when precision is the problem: twice as many chunks bring in more neighbouring-product clauses.
D **OE** More retrieval for a clause that is already found **97%** of the time; the noise around it is the problem.
E **SD** A sign: **17** irrelevant chunks still reach the context, and many do not name their product at all.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.6 · Atlas A3 ; Dock Walk Station 2 ; Dock Gym station 3.6

28 **Answer B + E** obj 3.3 · Accuracy–latency trade-offs · select 2 # number decides · ↔ leans on D1
The tell must return its triage decision within 6 s at p95
B ✓ A decision is recorded with its rejected alternative and the number that ruled it out: **90.8%** < **92%**.
E ✓ Constraint, dial, direction and number: **5.4 s** clears **6 s** and accuracy stays at **95%**, above the **92%** bar.
A **CM** Ignores what the SLA times, the complete triage decision; streaming cuts time to first token only.
C **OE** Three agents for three fixed calls adds cost and coordination; parallel tool calls in one agent give the same saving.
D **VG** Parallel calls do not speed a lookup up; the wait becomes the slowest call: **7.8** − **4.0** + **1.6** = **5.4 s**.
↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.3 · Atlas A1 ; Dock Walk Station 6 ; Dock Gym station 3.3

29 **Answer A + C + D** obj 3.5 · RAG pipeline: chunking & indexing · select 3 # number decides

The tell roughly 7.5 million tokens

A ✓ A rate without its zone and band headers is a number with no meaning; tables stay with their headers.

C ✓ Frequent updates need scheduled re-indexing; version labels and dropping stale chunks stop withdrawn rates being quoted.

D ✓ The skip-RAG option applies under about **200k** tokens; **7.5** million is far beyond it and beyond any context window.

B **VG** Calls it precision, but a headerless row loses the zone and band that give its numbers meaning.

E **CM** Ignores the size: **7.5** million tokens is far past the ~**200k** skip-RAG threshold and does not fit a context window.

↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.5 · Atlas A2 ; Dock Walk Station 1 ; Dock Gym station 3.5

30 **Answer A + C** obj 3.6 · Retrieval strategy · select 2 ⇄ head-to-head

The tell without breaking the ones that work

A ✓ Hybrid search: keyword matching catches exact codes like G7-FF, and the embeddings keep handling paraphrased questions.

C ✓ An order number is an exact key into a table; a structured lookup returns the one right row, which similarity search cannot guarantee.

B **CM** Fixes codes but breaks the paraphrase questions that work today; keyword alone fails on meaning.

D **OE** Adds a planning loop where two fixed routes chosen by data shape fix both failures.

E **VG** Semantic vectors blur near-identical codes by design; exact codes need keyword matching, and order IDs need a lookup.

↻ Revisit: D3 Loading Dock · obj 3.6 · Atlas A3 ; Dock Walk Station 2 ; Dock Gym station 3.6